THE URBAN VERNACULAR

Weaving together Rajputana grandeur, Mughal refinement and Deccan grit, in this home, history is felt in every hand-carved bracket and woven silk partition

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Forget the cookie-cutter minimalism of modern high-rises; this Mumbai residence is a soulful revival of the Marathi wada, reimagined for the 21st-century urbanite. The traditional wada has always been more than an architectural form; it is a cultural tapestry woven from Deccan sensibilities and layered spaces of engagement. Once an emblem of opulence for the family unit, this historic typology finds a new voice in here. By drawing on ancestral memory and the city's effortless blend of eras, the design transforms a modern apartment into a sanctuary that honours movement, craftsmanship and the soulful essence of Maharashtra.



A Ceremonial Threshold

The design narrative begins at the *mahadwar*, a grand entrance designed to declare prosperity through intricate craftsmanship. A traditional door serves as the anchor, flanked by hand-carved *Ashtavinayak* panels and a classic elephant bracket featuring a functional bell. Even the *dindidarwaza* or traditional peep door is integrated here, serving as a symbolic nod to legacy while defining the transition from the bustling outside world to the private indoor realm.

Shaping the Living Spaces

Central to the home's identity is the *sopa*, the pillared, semi-open vestibule typical of Marathi wadas. Inspired by the arched niches (*konade*) that once held oil lamps, the living room elevation uses wooden arches and linear rhythms to create a sense of historical continuity. To solve the challenge of a transitional zone that threatened to split the room, a bespoke linear partition was created. This unit acts as a storytelling device, displaying a curated collection of Dokra art, Panchaloha sculptures and Dabbawalla motifs that trace the family's geographical journey.